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valence shell. As the number of valence electrons remains same for the elements in same group, the maximum valence also remains the same. However, in a period the number of valence electrons increases, hence the valence also increases.

Table 3.16 Variation of valence in groups

Alkali Metals (Group 1)			Group 15		
Element	No. of electrons in valence shell	Valence	Element	No. of electrons in valence shell	Valence
Li	1	1	N	5	3, 5
Na	1	1	P	5	3, 5
K	1	1	As	5	3, 5
Rb	1	1	Sb	5	3, 5
Cs	1	1	Bi	5	3, 5
Fr	1	1			

Table 3.17 Variation of valence in period (1st period)

Element	Li	Be	B	C	N	O	F	Ne
No. of electrons in valence shell	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Valence (Combining capacity)	1	2	3	4	5, 3	6, 2	7, 1	8, 0

In addition to that some elements have variable valence. For example, most of the elements of group 15 which have 5 valence electrons show two valences 3 and 5. Similarly transition metals and inner transition metals also show variable oxidation states.

3.6.1 Anomalous properties of second period elements:

As we know, the elements of the same group show similar physical and chemical properties. However, the first element of each group differs from other members of the group in certain properties. For example, lithium and beryllium form more covalent compounds, unlike the alkali and alkali earth metals which predominantly form ionic compounds. The elements of the second period have only four orbitals (2s & 2p) in the valence shell and have a maximum co-valence of 4, whereas the other members of the subsequent periods have more orbitals in their valence shell and shows higher valences. For example, boron forms BF_4^- and aluminium forms AlF_6^{3-}